

NEWSLETTER 1

ROOT

Kick-Off Meeting –
Belgrade, Serbia
4–7 February 2026



Kick-Off Meeting in Belgrade

The first transnational project meeting was held in Belgrade, Republic of Serbia, from **4 to 7 February 2026**, hosted by **Creative Station**.

The meeting gathered all project partners to formally launch implementation, align responsibilities, and define the roadmap for the first operational phase of the project (M4–M6).

About the Project

Project acronym: ROOT

Project title: Rural Opportunities—
and Outreach for Tomorrow

ROOT is CBY Erasmus+ project, (No. 101243317) focused on strengthening youth opportunities in rural areas through innovation, digital skills, agrotourism, and policy engagement.

The project supports young people and youth workers in developing practical competences that connect local resources with sustainable economic and social development.

ROOT–New Partnership



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Over two intensive working days, partners discussed:

- WP structure and interdependencies
- Responsibilities and timelines
- Financial management and budget allocation
- Milestones and deliverables
- Internal Quality Assurance Plan (WP1)
- Survey methodology and youth needs analysis (WP2)
- Preparation of Country Reports and Gap Analyses
- Development of the Youth Worker Handbook and Training Framework (WP3)
- Conceptual framework for the Digital Agrotourism Academy (WP4)
- Policy Pathways & Recommendations (WP5)
- Dissemination strategy and impact planning (WP6)

Key Outcomes of the Meeting

- Agreement on the **methodology** for the youth needs survey
- Definition of **country-level** analytical responsibilities
- Finalisation of the internal **quality assurance** structure
- Strategic planning for **training activities** and youth exchange
- Confirmation of **dissemination and impact** indicators
- Beyond the formal agenda, the meeting strengthened collaboration and **trust among partners**, reinforcing the project's shared vision.





Cultural Visit

As part of the **Kick-Off Meeting programme**, partners visited **Perkov Salaš** on **Fruška Gora**, a well-known example of a successful family-run rural agrotourism initiative in Serbia.

Originally developed from a small traditional farm, the business gradually expanded by combining local food production, hospitality, and cultural heritage activities into a sustainable rural enterprise.

The visit provided valuable insight into how one entrepreneurial family transformed agricultural tradition into a viable and innovative rural tourism model closely aligned with the ROOT project objectives.

Looking Forward

In the upcoming months, the consortium will focus on:

- Conducting the youth needs survey and preparing Country Reports
- Developing the Youth Worker Handbook
- Designing the Digital Agrotourism Academy framework
- Preparing pilot training activities
- Establishing dissemination channels and stakeholder engagement mechanisms

ROOT is now fully operational and moving into the implementation phase with a clear strategic direction and strong partner commitment.



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MEET THE PARTNERS

COORDINATOR



PARTNERS:



Jordan Youth Innovation Forum
الملتقى الأردني للإبداع الشبابي



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